

TikTok for Developers

Open API Reference & cURL Guide

Login Kit

Display API

Research API

OAuth 2.0

Prepared for the Influencer App project

Source: developers.tiktok.com/doc • Generated 2026-06-07

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1. Overview

TikTok's open platform is a set of REST APIs. Almost everything is built around **OAuth 2.0**: a TikTok user must **log in to your app and grant permission (scopes)** before you can read their data. You then call the APIs with that user's `access_token`.

Key rule: To pull a user's data (profile, followers, video engagement), that user **must log in** to your system and authorize the requested scopes. You cannot pull a random influencer's private stats without their login. The only no-login option is the **Research API**, which is restricted to approved non-profit / academic research.

2. Authentication Flow (Login Kit)

1. **Authorize** — Redirect the user to TikTok's authorization page. They log in & tap **Allow**.
2. **Get code** — TikTok redirects back to your `redirect_uri` with a `code`.
3. **Exchange token** — Your server swaps the `code` for an `access_token` + `refresh_token`.
4. **Call APIs** — Use `Authorization: Bearer {access_token}` to call Display API.
5. **Refresh** — When the token expires, use the `refresh_token` to get a new one.

3. OAuth APIs

3.1 Authorization Request

REDIRECT

Meaning: Sends the user to TikTok to log in and approve your app. This is the "Login with TikTok" button. Returns a one-time `code` to your redirect URI.

GET <https://www.tiktok.com/v2/auth/authorize/>

```
# Build this URL and open it in the user's browser
https://www.tiktok.com/v2/auth/authorize/
?client_key=CLIENT_KEY
&scope=user.info.basic,user.info.profile,user.info.stats,video.list
&response_type=code
&redirect_uri=https://yourapp.com/callback
&state=random_csrf_string
```

3.2 Exchange Code for Access Token POST

Meaning: Your backend trades the one-time `code` for an `access_token` (used to call APIs) and a `refresh_token` (used to renew it).

POST <https://open.tiktokapis.com/v2/oauth/token/>

```
curl --location --request POST 'https://open.tiktokapis.com/v2/oauth/token/' \
--header 'Content-Type: application/x-www-form-urlencoded' \
--data-urlencode 'client_key=CLIENT_KEY' \
--data-urlencode 'client_secret=CLIENT_SECRET' \
--data-urlencode 'code=AUTH_CODE_FROM_REDIRECT' \
--data-urlencode 'grant_type=authorization_code' \
--data-urlencode 'redirect_uri=https://yourapp.com/callback'
```

Returns: `access_token`, `refresh_token`, `open_id`, `expires_in`, `refresh_expires_in`, `scope`, `token_type`.

3.3 Refresh Access Token POST

Meaning: Access tokens expire (~24h). Use the refresh token to get a new access token without making the user log in again.

POST <https://open.tiktokapis.com/v2/oauth/token/>

```
curl --location --request POST 'https://open.tiktokapis.com/v2/oauth/token/' \
--header 'Content-Type: application/x-www-form-urlencoded' \
--data-urlencode 'client_key=CLIENT_KEY' \
--data-urlencode 'client_secret=CLIENT_SECRET' \
--data-urlencode 'grant_type=refresh_token' \
--data-urlencode 'refresh_token=REFRESH_TOKEN'
```

3.4 Revoke Access POST

Meaning: Disconnects the user / invalidates the token (e.g. when a user unlinks their TikTok account from your app).

POST <https://open.tiktokapis.com/v2/oauth/revoke/>

```
curl --location --request POST 'https://open.tiktokapis.com/v2/oauth/revoke/' \
--header 'Content-Type: application/x-www-form-urlencoded' \
--data-urlencode 'client_key=CLIENT_KEY' \
--data-urlencode 'client_secret=CLIENT_SECRET' \
--data-urlencode 'token=ACCESS_TOKEN'
```

4. Display API (for your logged-in users)

Works only for users who logged in to your app and granted the scope. This is the **main API for an influencer app**.

4.1 Get User Info GET

Meaning: Returns the logged-in user's profile — name, avatar, bio, and (with stats scopes) follower / following / likes / video counts.

GET <https://open.tiktokapis.com/v2/user/info/?fields=...>

```
curl --location 'https://open.tiktokapis.com/v2/user/info/?fields=open_id,union_id,avatar_url,display_name,bio_description,profile_deep_link,is_verified,follower_count,following_count,likes_count,video_count' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer ACCESS_TOKEN'
```

Field	Meaning	Scope required
open_id / union_id	Unique user IDs in your app	user.info.basic
display_name	Public nickname	user.info.basic
avatar_url	Profile picture URL	user.info.basic
bio_description	Profile bio text	user.info.profile
profile_deep_link	Link to their TikTok profile	user.info.profile
is_verified	Blue-check verified status	user.info.profile
follower_count	 Number of followers	user.info.stats
following_count	Accounts they follow	user.info.stats
likes_count	 Total likes received	user.info.stats
video_count	Number of posted videos	user.info.stats

4.2 List User's Videos POST

Meaning: Returns a paginated list of the logged-in user's own videos, including engagement metrics (views, likes, comments, shares) per video.

POST <https://open.tiktokapis.com/v2/video/list/?fields=...>

```
curl --location --request POST 'https://open.tiktokapis.com/v2/video/list/?fields=id,title,video_description,duration,cover_image_url,share_url,embed_link,create_time,view_count,like_count,comment_count,share_count' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer ACCESS_TOKEN' \
--header 'Content-Type: application/json' \
--data '{ "max_count": 20 }'
# Use the returned "cursor" + "has_more" to page through all videos
```

4.3 Query Specific Videos POST

Meaning: Look up engagement for specific video IDs (up to 20). Useful to refresh stats of known videos. Only returns videos owned by the authorized user.

POST <https://open.tiktokapis.com/v2/video/query/?fields=...>

```
curl --location --request POST 'https://open.tiktokapis.com/v2/video/query/?fields=id,title,view_count,like_count,comment_count,share_count,cover_image_url,share_url' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer ACCESS_TOKEN' \
--header 'Content-Type: application/json' \
--data '{ "filters": { "video_ids": ["123456789", "987654321"] } }'
```

Video field	Meaning
view_count	 Number of views
like_count	 Likes
comment_count	 Comments
share_count	 Shares
title / video_description	Caption text
cover_image_url	Thumbnail image
share_url / embed_link	Links to the video
duration / create_time / id	Length, post time, video ID

Scope for 4.2 & 4.3: `video.list`. Limit: up to 20 video IDs per request.

5. Research API (any public user — research only)

Access restricted: Requires a separate TikTok approval and is limited to **non-profit academic research** in the US/EU. Commercial influencer apps are usually rejected. Listed here for completeness.

5.1 Query User Info POST

Meaning: Look up a public user's stats by username — without them logging in.

POST <https://open.tiktokapis.com/v2/research/user/info/?fields=...>

```
curl --location --request POST 'https://open.tiktokapis.com/v2/research/user/info/?fields=display_name,bio_description,avatar_url,is_verified,follower_count,following_count,likes_count,video_count' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer ACCESS_TOKEN' \
--header 'Content-Type: application/json' \
--data '{ "username": "some_creator" }'
```

5.2 Query Videos POST

Meaning: Search public videos by conditions (hashtag, keyword, region, date) and read their engagement (views, likes, comments, shares).

POST <https://open.tiktokapis.com/v2/research/video/query/?fields=...>

```
curl --location --request POST 'https://open.tiktokapis.com/v2/research/video/query/?fields=id,video_description,create_time,region_code,view_count,like_count,comment_count,share_count,username,hashtag_names' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer ACCESS_TOKEN' \
--header 'Content-Type: application/json' \
--data '{ "query": { "and": [ { "operation": "EQ", "field_name": "username", "field_values": ["some_creator"] } ] }, "start_date": "20260101", "end_date": "20260131", "max_count": 20 }'}
```

6. What is NOT available

❌ **No Live Stream API.** TikTok's official platform has **no** API to start a livestream, or to read live chat / gifts / viewer counts. There are no live webhook events either. The only ways people read live data are **unofficial** libraries (TikTok-Live-Connector, TikTokLive) that reverse-engineer the internal WebCast protocol — these are against TikTok's Terms of Service and can break at any time.

- ❌ Go live / stream control — none
- ❌ Live chat, gifts, real-time viewers — none (officially)
- ❌ Reading another user's private data without their login — none
- ❌ User-level total view count — not exposed (only per-video view_count)

7. Summary of all APIs

API	Endpoint	Method	Meaning / Use	Login?
Authorize	/v2/auth/authorize/	GET	"Login with TikTok" — get code	—
Token Exchange	/v2/oauth/token/	POST	Code → access_token	—
Refresh Token	/v2/oauth/token/	POST	Renew expired token	—
Revoke	/v2/oauth/revoke/	POST	Disconnect user	—
Get User Info	/v2/user/info/	GET	Profile + follower/like/video counts	✅ Yes
List Videos	/v2/video/list/	POST	User's videos + engagement	✅ Yes
Query Videos	/v2/video/query/	POST	Specific videos' engagement	✅ Yes
Research User	/v2/research/user/info/	POST	Any public user stats	❌ (approval)
Research Videos	/v2/research/video/query/	POST	Search public videos	❌ (approval)
Live Stream	—	—	Not available	—